and religion in the country. Overall, a high 48 per cent believe democracy in India is in danger compared to 39 per cent holding the opposite view.

Despite these hiccups, the odds remain in favour of Modi as the best leader to navigate India through these turbulent times. Over 60 per cent are worried about the impact of Trump's tariffs on India's exports. Importantly for Modi, in the battle of perceptions, 54 per cent blame America for the breakdown in Indo-US trade relations, and only 22 per cent think India goofed. The electorate also appreciates Modi's standing up to Trump's bullying, with 61 per cent asserting that India must not compromise on its interests but continue negotiating with the US.

For the prime minister, the immediate priority is minimising the impact of US tariffs on exporters and focusing on NextGen reforms to boost the economy. The rationalising of multiple slabs in the Goods and Services Tax (GST) by Diwali promises to provide the much-needed impetus. With a majority of respondents saying they find it difficult to start and run a business in India, the Modi government needs to ensure 'ease of doing business' becomes more than a catchy slogan. A large section of respondents feel the government has not done enough to support small businesses and that bureaucracy is a major hurdle to India's economic development. Half the respondents believe that all the talk of India becoming the world's fourth-largest economy is just a symbolic achievement that does little to benefit the common man. A third believe that the much-touted global economic image of India is at variance with the quality of infrastructure and public services in the country. All conditions that speak of an adversity Modi can convert into opportunity, a skill of which he is a past master. ■

THE POLL REFLECTS THE GROWING PUBLIC DISCOMFORT WITH MISUSE OF DEMOCRATIC INSTITUTIONS, INCLUDING CENTRAL AGENCIES, AND THE POLITICISATION OF STATE GOVERNORS

Methodology

The INDIA TODAY Mood of the Nation (MOTN) poll was conducted by CVoter, a globally renowned name in the field of socio-economic research, between July 1, 2025, and August 14, 2025, interviewing 54,788 respondents in all Lok Sabha segments across all states. In addition to these samples, an additional 152,038 interviews from CVoter's regular tracker data over the past 24 weeks were also analysed for the long-term trendline in projections calculation of votes and seats. Thus, the opinion of a total of 206,826 respondents was considered for this MOTN report. The margin of error is +/- 3 per cent at macro level and +/- 5 per cent at micro level of reporting, with 95 per cent confidence level.

From May 2009 onwards, the CVoter Tracker has been carried out each week, 52 waves in a calendar year, in 11 national languages, across all states and UTs in India, with a target sample size of 60,000 samples each quarter. The average response rate is 55 per cent. Starting January 1, 2019, CVoter has been carrying the tracker on a daily basis, using the rollover sample of seven days for tracker analysis.

All these polls are based on a random probability sample as used in the globally standardised methodology, carried out by trained researchers across all geographic and demographic segments. This survey is based on Computer Assisted Telephone Interviews (CATI) of adult respondents across all segments. Standard Random Digit Dialling (RDD) is used to draw random numbers covering all frequency series allocated to all operators across all telecom circles in India.

CVoter ensures proper representative analysis by statistical weighing of the data to make it representative of the local population as per the latest census figures. The data is weighted to the known census profile, including gender, age, education, income, religion, caste, urban/rural and vote recalls for the last Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha elections. For the analytics, CVoter uses its proprietary algorithm to calculate the provincial and regional vote share based on the split-voter phenomenon.

CVoter follows the code of professional ethics and practices drafted by the World Association of Public Opinion Research and the official guidelines on opinion polling as instructed by the Press Council of India. ■